

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When a grown-up helps can vegetables or meat, why do they use a special pot that gets hotter than boiling water?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because the extra heat helps make sure any harmful germs are all gone.

FUN FACT

Some foods need extra heat to keep them safe from germs that can make people sick!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do grown-ups use a special kind of cooker called a pressure canner when they preserve foods like vegetables and meats?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because it gets hotter than boiling water, so it helps keep the food safe by getting rid of tiny bad germs.

FUN FACT

Did you know? The pressure canner gets hotter than boiling water to make sure any hidden germs that might make people sick are killed!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When you watch a grown-up use a special pot to preserve foods that are not very sour, what do you see them do before the pot gets really pressurized?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

They let steam come out for about 10 minutes to push the air out first.

FUN FACT

Letting steam come out first helps the pot get very hot, keeping the food safe to eat later!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When watching a grown-up use a pressure canner to preserve low acid foods, why is it important for them to have the dial checked every year?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

So the dial shows the right pressure and helps keep the food safe.

FUN FACT

A correctly working dial helps grown-ups know the right pressure to keep the food safe while preserving it!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When a grown-up is preserving foods using a special pot that cooks under pressure, why might they need to make the pressure stronger if they are cooking on a tall mountain?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because water boils at a lower temperature on tall mountains, so more pressure helps the food cook hot enough to stay safe.

FUN FACT

Did you know that on tall mountains, water boils at a cooler temperature, so cooks adjust their pots to keep food safe!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When a grown-up uses a pressure canner to preserve foods that need extra heat, how do the two kinds of pressure gauges help keep things safe?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

A dial gauge shows the exact pressure number on a dial, and a weighted gauge wiggles or rocks to keep the pressure steady.

FUN FACT

Both types of gauges help keep the canner at the right pressure to make sure the food stays safe and tasty!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When watching a grown-up use a pressure canner to preserve vegetables, why do they let steam come out for a few minutes before starting the timer?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because letting out the steam helps the canner get very hot and cook the food safely.

FUN FACT

Releasing steam first helps the canner reach the right temperature so the food stays safe to eat!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do grown-ups use a special kind of cooker called a pressure canner instead of an oven or microwave when preserving low acid foods like vegetables or meat?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because only a pressure canner gets hot enough and keeps the heat steady to make the food safe by killing germs that could make people sick.

FUN FACT

Did you know? Only the steam inside a pressure canner gets hot enough to safely kill tiny germs, like those that cause botulism, in low acid foods.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When canning meat or poultry, what type of process time should you follow?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Use the exact process times and pressures recommended for the specific product.

FUN FACT

Following exact times keeps low acid foods from causing food poisoning.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When watching a grown-up open a jar of home-canned food that has a bulging lid or smells strange, what should you notice happens to the jar and what should the grown-up do with the food?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

The lid looks swollen and the food smells bad, so the grown-up throws the food away carefully to stay safe.

FUN FACT

Some harmful germs can make food unsafe even if the food looks and smells normal!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why is it important to remove as much fat as possible from meat before canning?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Fat can rise and cause jars not to seal properly during processing.

FUN FACT

Less fat means safer sealing and better canned food quality!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When a grown-up is getting home-canned meat or poultry ready to eat, why do they heat it by boiling for a certain time first?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To make sure any germs or harmful stuff are gone and the food is safe to eat.

FUN FACT

Heating home-canned food before eating helps make it extra safe by getting rid of anything that might make you sick.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When placing jars in a pressure canner, why do you need to leave some space (headspace) at the top of the jar?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To allow food to expand and steam to circulate during processing.

FUN FACT

Headspace helps food cook evenly and seals the jar better!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When a grown-up uses a pressure canner to preserve food in jars, can they put two layers of jars inside at the same time?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Yes, if the canner is tall enough and a wire rack is placed between the layers so steam can reach all jars.

FUN FACT

Steam needs space to move around and touch every jar so the food inside stays safe.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why is overpacking jars with too much food dangerous in pressure canning low acid foods?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because packed jars heat unevenly and may not reach safe temperatures throughout.

FUN FACT

Just the right amount helps heat get everywhere to kill bacteria.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What are the signs of spoilage to watch for in low acid canned foods?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Cloudy liquid, bubbles inside the jar, off smell, mold, or bulging lids.

FUN FACT

Some spoiled low acid foods can be dangerous even if they look okay.

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When watching an adult can foods like vegetables or meat at home, why is it important they use recipes that have been carefully tested?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because these tested recipes make sure any harmful germs and poisons are completely removed, keeping the food safe to eat.

FUN FACT

Only recipes that have been carefully tested by experts can make sure low-acid foods are safe to preserve at home!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When watching a grown-up use a pressure canner to preserve low-acid foods, why is it important to let the canner cool down slowly instead of cooling it off quickly?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because cooling it slowly helps keep the food safe by letting the heat finish killing germs.

FUN FACT

Letting the pressure canner cool down slowly helps the heat finish its job to keep food safe inside the jars!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

When adults help preserve low acid foods, why don't they use a microwave to keep the food safe?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because microwaves do not heat the food evenly or hot enough to make sure all bacteria are killed.

FUN FACT

Pressure canners are special pots that help heat all parts of the food evenly and safely to keep it good for a long time!

Source: PNW 450 Canning smoked fish at home

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is one way to safely dispose of home-canned low acid food that looks spoiled but is still sealed?

LOW ACID FOODS



Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Label it 'Poison: Danger, Do Not Eat' and throw it in a sealed trash bag.

FUN FACT

Some bad bacteria make poisons that can hurt people and pets, even if the food looks okay!

Source: PNW 361 Canning meat poultry game